RESEARCH CV

1. Research assignments

2025. Examiner, Master's Thesis in Bilingualism, Centre for Research on Bilingualism, Stockholm University.

2025. Expert advisor on project investigating the effect of extended time on test-taker performance, Tisus reading test, Department of Swedish Language and Multilingualism. Commissioned to perform empirical and computational analyses of test-taker performance and test-taker impressions, as well as to contribute expert input on study design, as part of a national initiative.

2018. Expert advisor in a group commissioned by the Swedish National Agency for Education to develop material for assessing student literacy in adult education. The target group was teachers of SFI (Swedish for Immigrants) and Swedish as a Second Language in municipal adult education (Komvux). The project manager was Judith Crystal at the Department of Swedish Language and Multilingualism, and the material was published in 2019 (Kartläggningsmaterial för nyanlända vuxnas litteracitet). My role was to partake in the development of activities and assessment material for teachers, as well as pilot testing the material at schools around the country prior to its publication.

2017-2019. Organizing pretesting of the reading comprehension test of Tisus at upper secondary schools in the City of Stockholm. This work included implementing the pretest, analyzing the results, and reporting back to the participating schools as well as to the test item writing team.

2. External grants and research projects

2026. Den humanistiske fakultet digitals utlysning av såkornmidler. Infrastructure funding for force aligning and annotating the NoTa corpus. Co-applicant, 100 000 NOK.

2025. Riksbankens Jubileumsfond. Research initiation grant: *Ett tvärvetenskapligt och tvärspråkligt samarbetsinitiativ för studiet av hur hjärnan hanterar talspråklig variation*. As sole applicant, I secured initial phase grant funding from *Riksbankens Jubileumsfond* (RJ) to lead an international, interdisciplinary research initiative investigating how the human brain processes spectral information for speech normalization across talkers. The project brought together key collaborators, including Santiago Barreda (UC Davis) and T Florian Jaeger (University of Rochester), and expanded to include David Reby (St-Étienne) and Andrey Anikin (Lund University) to incorporate cross-species perspectives on sound perception. As part of this initiative, I coordinated research visits, departmental seminars for researchers and PhD students at Stockholm University and KTH and co-organized a dedicated workshop at the 2026 *Neurolinguistics in Sweden* conference. The workshop featured invited speakers from the University of Delaware (Kasia Hitczenko), University of Sussex (Ediz Sohoglu), and the Slovak Academy of Sciences (Ondrej Such), who joined our advisory network to review future grant proposals. My role involved managing the RJ project grant, coordinating international guest visits and conference logistics, leading joint proposal development, and establishing an international advisory network to position the team for upcoming Swedish and US funding applications. Sole applicant. 182 000 SEK.

2024. Elisabeth och Herman Rhodins minne. Financial support. Sole applicant. 55 000 SEK.

2024. John and Johanna Håkansson foundation, Birger Calleman foundation. Funding for participation in summer school Methods in Language Sciences, Bayesian data analysis, Ghent University. Sole applicant. 17 000 SEK.

2023. Helge Ax:son Johnson foundation. Funding for inviting leading researcher: *Strengthening inter-disciplinary connections across the cognitive, social, and language sciences*. Main applicant. 70 000 SEK.
2023. The Board of Human Science, Faculty of Humanities, Stockholm University**.** Strategic funds, "black box" including invitation of leading researchers and collaborative initiatives: *Strengthening inter-disciplinary connections across the cognitive, social, and language sciences*. Main applicant. 42 000 SEK.
2023. The Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences. Funding for research visit (University of Rochester, USA; Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität, Münich; University of Zürich, Switzerland). Sole applicant. 49 000 SEK.
2023. The Royal Swedish Academy of Letters, History and Antiquities. Funding for research visit and conference participation (ASA meeting 2023, Chicago; Human Language Processing Lab, University of Rochester). Sole applicant. 18 000 SEK.
2022-2023. Funding for Quality Assuring Activities, Faculty of Humanities, Stockholm University. In 2022, I co-founded the *PhD workshop for research skills (methods, reporting, and reproducibility)* together with a colleague, Maryann Tan. Over three years, this was a recurring event organized by PhD students at the Department of Swedish Language and Multilingualism, the Department of Linguistics at Stockholm University and the Department of Scandinavian Languages at Uppsala University. I was a co-organizer in the subsequent workshop in 2023 and served as an advisor for the workshop in 2024. The workshop was aimed at supporting doctoral students to acquire the skills necessary to meet the increasing demands of publishing in linguistics, psychology, cognitive sciences and related fields. The workshop covered subjects related to experimental research methods, simulation-based approaches, Bayesian statistics, and data management, and included presentations by both attendees and guest lecturers. My role involved applying for funding, developing a workshop program together with the PIs of the workshop (T Florian Jaeger and Chigusa Kurumada, University of Rochester), conference logistics (booking of travels, hotels, venue, food), budget planning, and reporting back to funders. In 2023: main applicant; 50 940 SEK. In 2022: co-applicant; 48 000 SEK.
2021. Kinander foundation. Grant for research study (data collection). Sole applicant. 34 000 SEK.

3. National and international cooperation

2020-2025. Member of the Human Language Processing Lab at the University of Rochester.
T. Florian Jaeger, University of Rochester (ongoing, 3 co-authored publications)
Santiago Barreda, University of California, Davis (ongoing, 1 co-authored publication)
Timo Roettger, University of Oslo (ongoing, 2 co-authored publications submitted)

4. Research network

2025-ongoing. Member of *International Phonetic Association*.
2022-ongoing. Member of *the Swedish Cognitive Science Society*.
2016-2019. Member of *Association of Language Testers in Europa (ALTE)* and *Norden ALTE*, organization for test item writers in Europe. Co-organization of and participation in Nordic and European conferences.
2016-2019. Member of Tisus reference group responsible for validating Tisus tests prior to pretesting and launching; representatives from the Swedish National Agency for Education, Tisus

test centers, Tisus item writing team, and item writing team of the National test of Swedish/Swedish as a Second Language at Uppsala University.

5. Visiting researcher

2023, October. Research visit (1 week) at the Institute of Phonetics and Speech Processing, Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität, München (host: James Kirby).
2023, October. Research visit (1 week) at the Department of Computational Linguistics, University of Zürich (host: Eleanor Chodroff).
2023, May. Research visit (2 weeks) at the Human Language Processing Lab at the University of Rochester (host: T Florian Jaeger).

6. Other

6.1 Awards

2026. Awardee of the International Association of Phonetics PhD Thesis Award

6.2 Conference presentations and invited talks

Persson, A., Barreda, S. & Jaeger, T.F. (2026). Incremental formant normalization: uniform scaling best explains human vowel perception. SweCog 2026, Uppsala, 27-28 October.

Persson, A. (2026). Speech perception and talker normalization: how the brain manages acoustic variation. Invited talk, workshop *Listening for interpreting: towards new empirical and theoretical frameworks in public service interpreting research*, Stockholm, 14-16 October.

Roettger, T. & **Persson, A**. 2026. *Exploring mechanisms that keep signals iconic* [presentation]. From the sound up. A workshop on vocal imitation, onomatopoeia, and the emergence of linguistic structure, Uppsala, September 16-18.
Barreda, S., Jaeger, T.F. & **Persson, A.** 2026. *A one-shot model for joint inferences of talker physiology and vowel recognition* [presentation]. Workshop Stable perception of spectral information across contexts: From normalization to adaptive category representations, Stockholm, June 11.
Persson, A. 2025. *Att undersöka hur hjärnan hanterar variation i vokalproduktion* [presentation]. Higher Seminar in Scandinavian Languages, Uppsala University, February 12, 2025.
Persson, A. 2024. *Investigating the role of pre-linguistic formant normalization in vowel perception* [presentation]. Nordic Speech Research Forum webinar, December 12, 2024.
Persson, A. & Jaeger, T.F. 2024. *Measuring the informativity of F3 for rounded and unrounded high-front vowels in Central Swedish* [presentation]. Proceedings from FONETIK 2024, Stockholm, June 3-5, 2024, 13-18. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.11396050
Persson, A. 2024. *The acoustic characteristics of Stockholm Swedish vowels* [poster]. FiNO 2024, Stockholm, February 23-25, 2024.
Persson, A., Tan, M. & Jaeger, T.F. 2023. *Towards stronger theories (& tests) of adaptive speech perception* [presentation]. Dept. of Computational Linguistics, University of Zürich.
Persson, A. 2023. *Comparing pre-linguistic normalization models against Swedish vowel data* [presentation]. Institute of Phonetics and Speech Processing, Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität, München
Persson, A. & Jaeger, T. F. 2023. *Comparing pre-linguistic normalization models against US English listeners' perception of natural and resynthesized vowels* [poster]. 184th Meeting of the

Acoustical Society of America. Journal of the Acoustical Society of America. 153, A77 https://doi.org/10.1121/10.0018219

Persson, A. & Jaeger, T. F. 2023. *Comparing pre-linguistic normalization models against US English listeners' vowel perception* [poster]. 184th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America. Journal of the Acoustical Society of America. 153, A77 https://doi.org/10.1121/10.0018218

Persson, A. & Jaeger, T. F. 2023. *Evaluating normalization accounts against the dense vowel space of Stockholm Swedish* [poster]. 184th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America. Journal of the Acoustical Society of America. 153, A370 https://doi.org/10.1121/10.0019201

Persson, A. & Jaeger, T. F. 2022. *Comparing pre-linguistic normalization against US English listeners' vowel perception* [presentation]. Experimental Linguistics 2022, Paris, France.

Persson, A. & Jaeger, T. F. 2022. *The role of prior experience in vowel perception* [poster]. SweCog 2022, Örebro.

Persson, A. 2019. *Familiarity effects in L1 and L2 accent processing* [poster]. L2 Pronunciation Research Symposium 2019, Jyväskylä, Finland.

Spolin, A. & **Persson, A.** 2018. *What do teachers need to know about test development and assessment?* [presentation] Teacher Training Special Interest Group. Association of Language Testers in Europe (ALTE), 52nd Meeting & Conference Day, Salamanca, Spanien.

Persson, A. 2018. *Tisus bedömarutbildning och bedömarträning* [presentation]. Norden ALTE, Köpenhamn, Danmark.